PART I · PITCH · TIPS

# When a note reads wrong

Most wrong notes come from a handful of slips. Name the slip first, then fix only that note: playing the whole line again rarely finds it.

TIP

### What you notice, what to check

| WHAT YOU NOTICE | CHECK | TURN TO |
|---|---|---|
| The left hand reads like the right | **the clef**: bass lines are G B D F A, not E G B D F | p. 32 |
| You land an octave too high or too low | **the Cs**: find Middle C first, then walk out to Bass C or Treble C | p. 23 |
| Notes above or below the staff slow you down | **the ledger lines**: step on from the nearest staff line | p. 36 |
| A sharp or flat vanishes, or stays too long | **the bar line**: a sign lasts only to the end of its bar | p. 40 |
| You play the black key on the wrong side | **the direction**: sharp goes right, flat goes left | p. 39 |
| Two notes sound too close or too far apart | **the interval**: count the notes, then the keys between | p. 45 |

EXAMPLE

### Spot the slip



?

*Sam played A. Wrong!*

1. **Check the clef first:** this is the bass clef, not the treble.
2. **Use the bass sentence:** the spaces are *All Cows Eat Grass*.
3. **The red note is in space 2:** the second word.

The note is **C** (*Cows*): Bass C. Sam read the bass staff with treble names (treble space 2 is A): the most common slip of all.

HOW TO

### Three checks before you read a new line

1. **The clefs:** which staff is treble, which is bass?
2. **The clef notes:** find treble G, bass F and Middle C, and read the other notes from them.
3. **The signs:** mark each sharp, flat or natural, and see where its bar ends.

THINK OF IT Like reading a map: find the big landmarks first, then the streets around them. A note far from every clef note is the one most often misread.